single Muslim candidate in the electoral race. Furthermore, the candidate nomination process revealed intensified scrutiny to verify candidate eligibility based on the 2010 electoral laws, in particular in relation to candidates' citizenship. As of 2 September 2015, eighty-eight candidates had been rejected by the UEC, with the majority coming from Rakhine State (twenty-eight) and Yangon Region (twenty-four). Following massive criticism of these decisions, including from the international community, several candidate rejections were later revoked. However, in Rakhine State, based on the combined effects of restrictions to political parties, voter disenfranchisement, and increased candidate scrutiny, Muslims have lost — with the exception of a few remaining voters who might have voted for the NLD — any electoral representation. This is quite dramatic, and adds to the series of future governance challenges and to the inheritance of a worsening human rights situation in Rakhine State with an unresolved citizenship problem. How the NLD will deal with the problems and interests of citizen and non-state Muslims who do not have any representative of their own in the legislatures remains to be seen.

IN SEARCH OF SOLUTIONS

Demands for reform by the former Burmese opposition and ethnic actors coincide with constitutional reform debates that have been part of the political transition process since it started. After the 2012 by-elections, expectations were high that significant changes of the 2008 Constitution could happen prior to 2015. The most prominent elements that many outside the hitherto governing elite want to see changed are the participation of military appointees in the legislature, the qualification criteria for presidential candidates which by design make Aung San Suu Kyi ineligible for this post, and the further establishment of a federal system, as well as the conditions for changing the constitution which is de facto not possible without military consent (see Lidauer 2014). Ethnic parties' demands for constitutional changes also include the possibility of electing chief ministers of states and regions directly, rather than have them appointed by the president from among elected or appointed state or region members of parliament, as is currently the case.

Despite the introduction of the draft bill for a national referendum to change the Constitution — which triggered the legal formalisation of TRC